1. Size and growth of business.

2. Complexities of business operations.

The governing body of the organization may change (i.e.) director, chairman of the companies, ministers in the cabinet may come and go but the secretary has to run the show, and promote the growth of the organiasation.



Fig. 8.1. Secretary

8.2.Kinds of Secretaries:

On the basis of the nature and functions of secretaries, we classify them as follow:

1. Ministry's or Department's Secretary: Every Government Department has a secretary and he acts as the executive head of the department. Secretary is the person who implements the decision taken by the department heads' He has to advise the Ministers in certain matters. The important functions performed by him include administrative function, advisory function, formulation of policies etc. Usually I.A.S officers are appointed as secretary to top level executives in certain organizations.

2. Private Secretary: Private Secretary or personal secretary is a person appointed by a person in high position such as Ministers, Senior Doctors, lawyers, Accountants etc., whose work requires close attention and cannot afford to spent time for routine activities. He keeps the confidence of his master and he is the right hand man of his employer.

Do You Know?

Since the Renaissance until the late 19th century, men involved in the daily correspondence and the activities of the powerful had assumed the title of secretary. Then the functions of the secretary varied and they are titled as general secretary, administrative secretary etc. As such less influential posts became more feminine and common in the public and private sectors, so new name was coined to describe them as personal assistant.

In 1870, Sir Isaac Pitman founded a school where students could qualify as shorthand writers to "professional and commercial men". Originally, this school was only for male students. In the 1880s, with the invention of the typewriter, more women began to enter the field and during the upcoming years, especially since World War I, the role of secretary has been primarily associated with women. By 1930s, fewer men were entering the field of secretaries.

3. Secretary of an Association or a Club: An association or a club is formed to serve for some common cause of its members, such as promoting art, science, music, sports, etc. The secretary

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